



“The challenge for India is to grow at high rates for the next three decades. This requires very personalised hand-holding of investors... It’s... [about] personally getting in touch with large MNCs, entrepreneurs, [and] convincing their CEOs and CFOs to come to India”

AMITABH KANT
INDIA’S G20 SHERPA



“A young and professional team has ushered in a ‘can do’ mindset. It is the team which seamlessly joins the dots and frames the picture. In effect, they have created a social ‘unicorn’; a start-up, which in place of a billion-dollar valuation, impacts over a billion people!”

ANAND MAHINDRA
CHAIRMAN, MAHINDRA GROUP



“Invest India is a unique platform for investors and businesses... It has played a key role in the digitalisation of the investor journey and revolutionised the investor engagement in India through portals such as National Single Window and India Investment Grid”

ANURAG JAIN
SECRETARY, DPIIT

to partner, help and support other countries, especially in sharing their learnings and best practices. “This has positioned Invest India as a trusted partner of other countries,” he says.

Still, there is work to be done. In the World Competitiveness Index, created by the Switzerland-based Institute of Management Development, India is ranked 37; China is 17. An EY-CII report says MNCs expect momentum on faster execution of infrastructure projects, ease of doing business, tax reforms, and implementation of trade agreements.

The last point is critical. India now has three economic partnership agreements with Japan, South Korea and the UAE, as well as two economic cooperation pacts with Malaysia and Singapore. Some experts question the need for FTAs with smaller trading partners like Canada, Australia, the UAE, and the UK. “Canada opens up North America for you now with the global shift happening. The UAE opens up the entire continent of Africa. That is a big market. These are the gateways,” defends Bagla. In terms of future challenges, the forces of deglobalisation and new global taxes on MNCs could also impact FDI flows. India’s story received a big jolt recently when MNCs like Ford, Metro, Holcim, Harley-Davidson and General Motors left the country.

But the corridors of Invest India are witnessing a flurry of activity with investors moving in and out. Bagla would like to have an Invest India desk at all major airports in the country. In fact, when he was asked to prepare a business plan for the next 10 years, he remarked that if all goes well, there should be no Invest India by 2035. “You will not need it,” he signs off. **BT**

@RajatMishra9518, @anandadhikari